Election Night Watch Guide, Nov. 3, 2026

Coverage start times and poll closings by hour, Eastern Time

1. **4 p.m.**
   CNN Election Night in America begins with Jake Tapper and Anderson Cooper
2. **5 p.m.**
   NBC News coverage begins on NBC and Peacock (most NBC stations join at 6:30 p.m.)
3. **5:30 p.m.**
   NBC's Big Board livestream starts on NBCNews.com, the NBC News app and YouTube; Peacock multiview opens
4. **6 p.m.**
   Polls close in most of Indiana and Kentucky. Fox News Channel coverage begins, simulcast on Fox Business
5. **7 p.m.**
   Polls close in Florida, Georgia, South Carolina, Vermont and Virginia. CBS News coverage and FOX News Audio begin
6. **7:30 p.m.**
   Polls close in North Carolina, Ohio and West Virginia
7. **8 p.m.**
   Polls close in Pennsylvania, Michigan, Texas, 15 other states and D.C.
8. **8:30 p.m.**
   Polls close in Arkansas
9. **9 p.m.**
   Polls close in Arizona, Colorado, Iowa, Louisiana, Minnesota, Nebraska, New Mexico, New York, Wisconsin and Wyoming
10. **10 p.m.**
    Polls close in Idaho, Montana, Nevada and Utah
11. **11 p.m.**
    Polls close in California, Oregon and Washington
12. **Midnight**
    Polls close in Alaska and Hawaii
13. **6 a.m. Wed.**
    NBC's broadcast coverage and the Fox Business simulcast end

My notes

Source: NBC News, Decision '26 release (Oct. 22, 2026); Fox News Media release (Oct. 23, 2026); CBS News release (Oct. 7, 2026); CNN release (Oct. 28, 2026); poll closing times for most of each state, from our story What Time Do Polls Close. ABC and PBS had not announced plans as of Oct. 31.